two-room apartment, with kitchenette and bath, completely furnished, and redecorated only half a year before, would be available half a block from the school from June 1 to September 1 at $60 a month. I sent off an acceptance, sight unseen. How bad could it be after all? Certainly the location was convenient, and we would have three months to find something better.

May 20 was the anniversary of my successful Doctor's Orals, and "a lot of good it's done me" was the gloomy comment in my diary. The next day, however, I completed the revision of "Grow Old Along with Me." It had taken me 6V2 weeks. On May 22, Pohl dropped around to pick up the new manuscript and deliver it to Doubleday.

5

On May 29, 1949, Bradbury called and got Gertrude on the phone. He told her that Doubleday was taking the revised "Grow Old Along with Me" and it would be out as a book the next January. Gertrude called me with the news, for I was at Windsor Place at the time.

I was delighted. It seemed a happy send-off.

But it was difficult to be altogether happy. I was leaving Columbia at last nearly fourteen years after I had first entered it, and although I had longed often enough to be through with it, now that I was really going to leave, it was hard to forget that I had spent half my life associated with it. Then, too, I was leaving New York City for the second time, nearly three years after having gotten out of the Army and returned, and this time it was not "for the duration"; it might be for all my life.

I remember I met old Professor Thomas on the Columbia campus on Friday, May 27, my last full day on campus. He was getting on in years now and walked with a cane.

I said to him, "Well, Professor Thomas, I'm leaving Columbia today after fourteen years."

I thought that the least he could do would be to break into tears, but he only banged his cane against the brick walk and said, "About time! About time!" turned, and tramped off.

Morris Kupchan, my predecessor on Elderfield's projects, was working in Boston now. He drove us to Boston on May 31, and there we saw what we had sublet at 42 Worcester Square in Boston. It was unbelievably horrible.